

State Review Learnings:

University of Arkansas – Pine Bluff

Traditional Route

On-Site Review: November 5–6, 2025

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, “Candidate Recruitment and Completion,” is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, “Preparing Candidates Effectively,” criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, “Supporting Workforce Needs,” are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two

BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two
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University of Arkansas - Pine Bluff

Traditional Route

Overall Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
APPROACHING	APPROACHING	APPROACHING

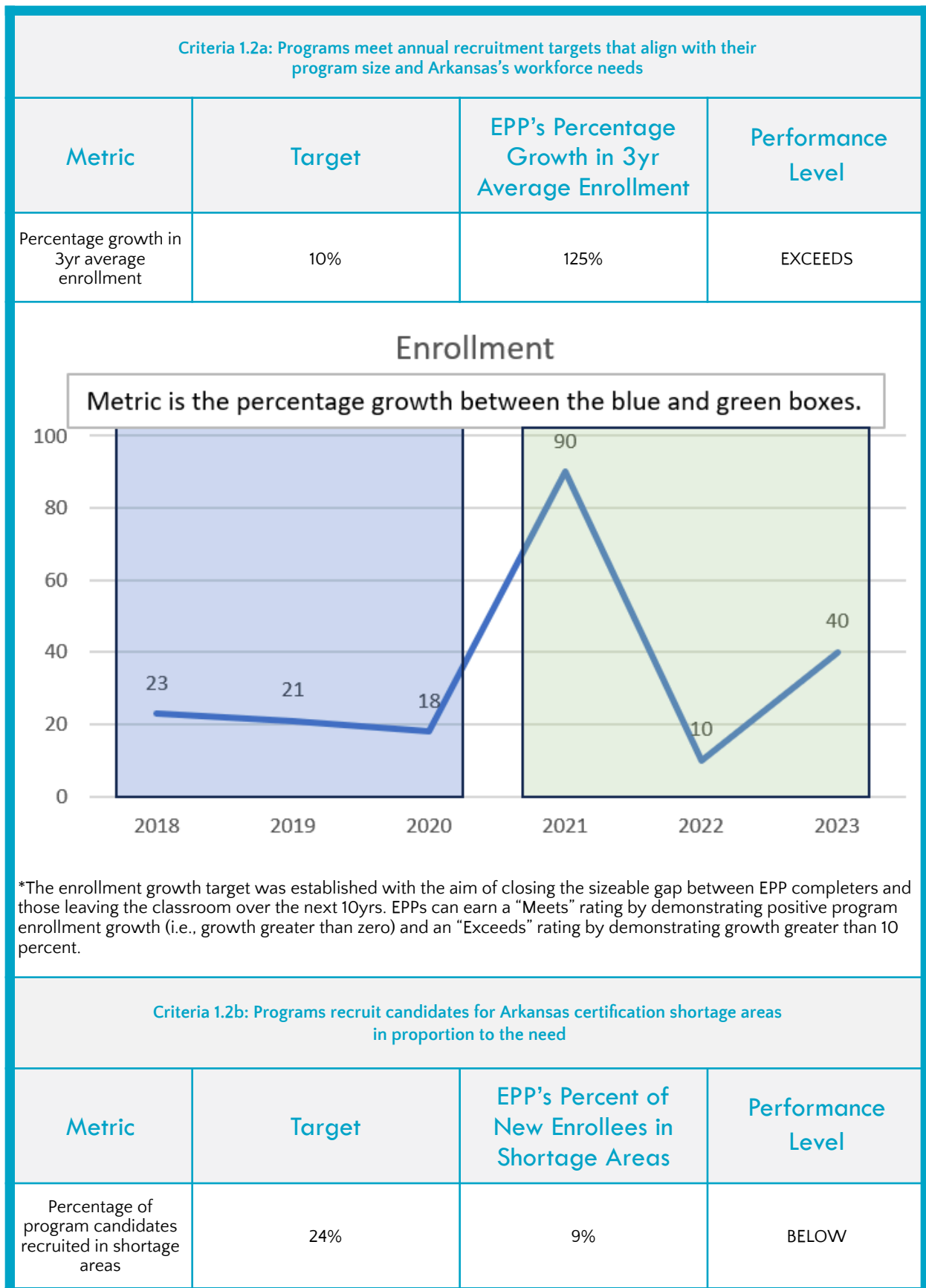
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion

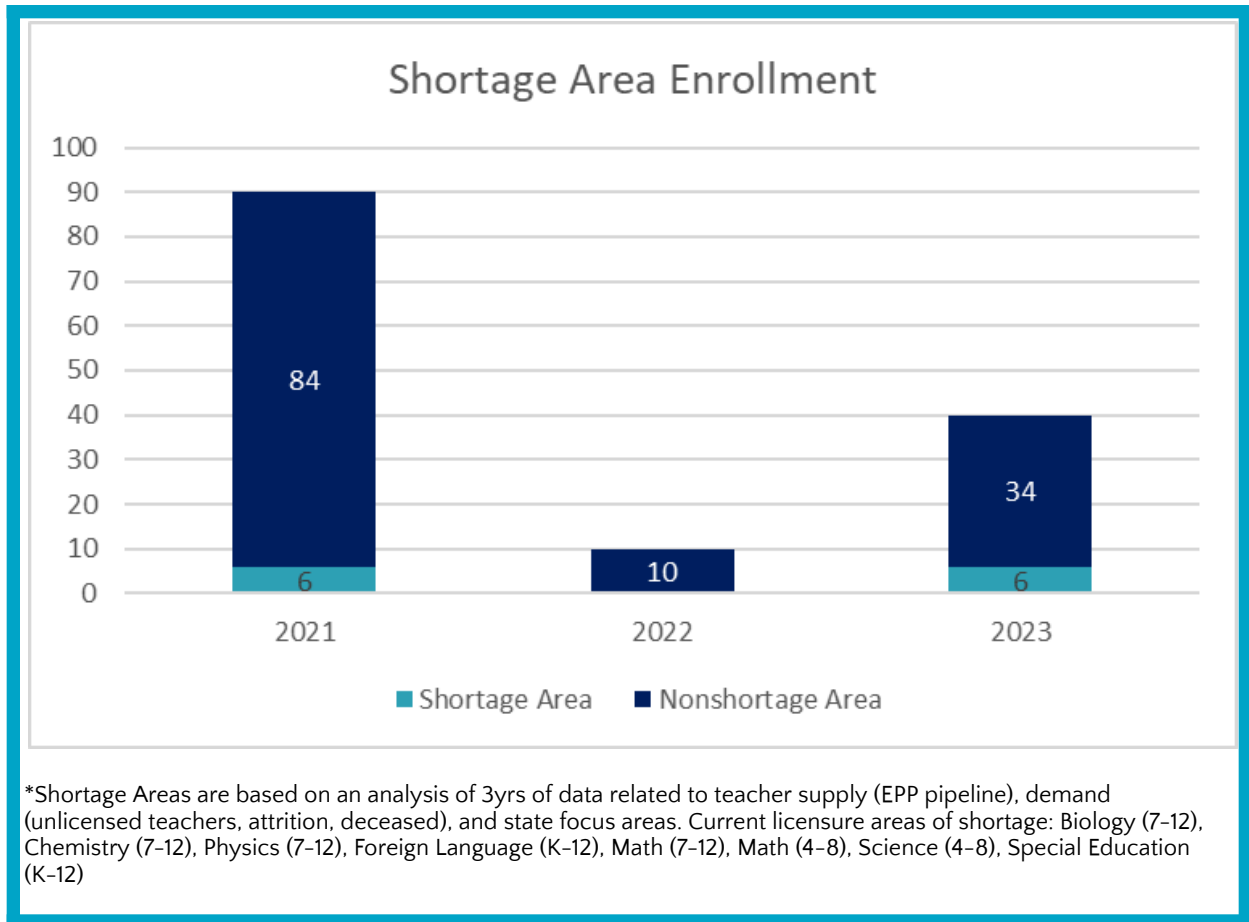
Standard 1 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	BELOW
Recommendations		
Recommendations: - Recruiting additional candidates to increase overall enrollment, and particularly in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. (Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2a) - Consider what additional supports candidates may need to increase the 3-year completion rate. (Focus Areas: Criteria 1.3a)		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	The UAPB Traditional program Annual Plan provides evidence-based strategies in response to data.

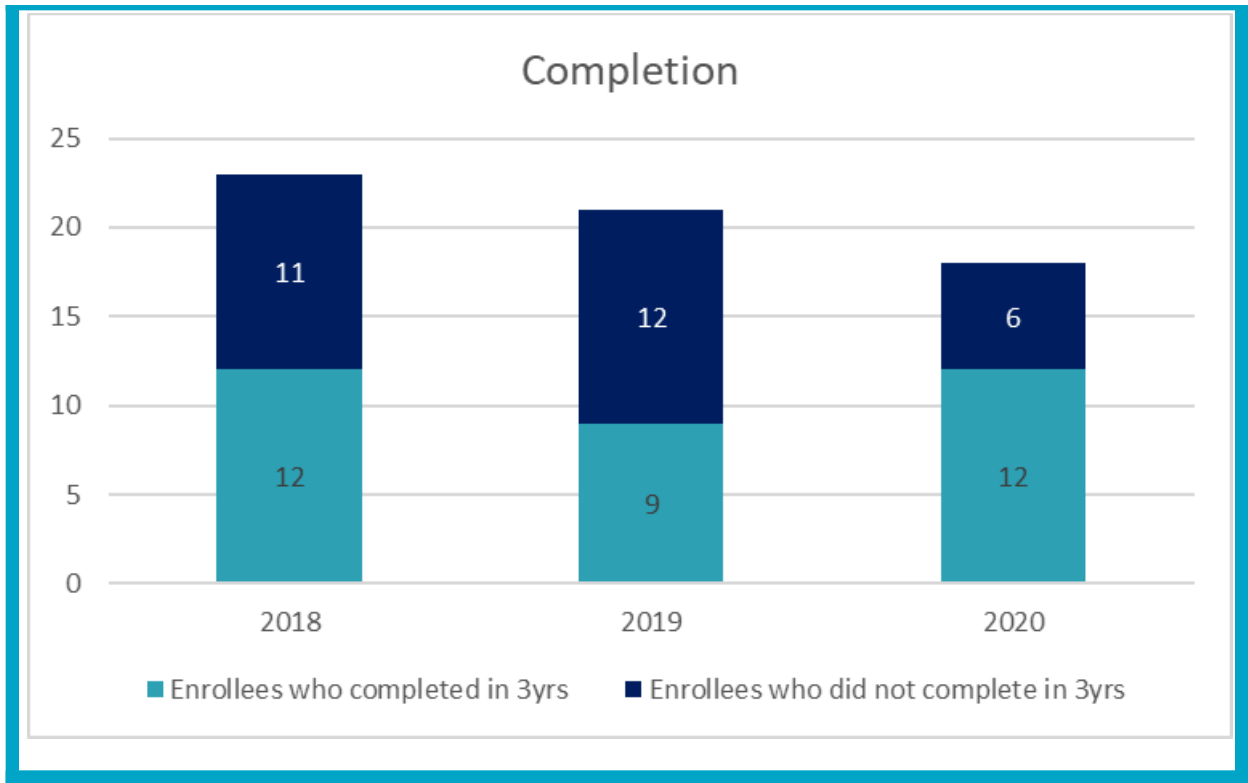
INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT





INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	53%	BELOW



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	APPROACHING	APPROACHING
Recommendations		
University of Arkansas – Pine Bluff’s traditional teacher preparation program has strong coursework aligned to the clinical experiences, and instructors and clinical supervisors are highlighted as effective and supportive. UAPB is well regarded by partner schools, and collaborative processes are in place with districts and schools to co-construct clinical experiences. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: • Create or revise an evaluation process to collect feedback from candidates and clinical supervisors regarding the effectiveness and support from the experienced mentor teacher (<i>Focus Area 2.2b Metric 1</i>) • Ensure all candidates receive consistent feedback from clinical supervisors and experienced mentor teachers that is aligned to the ATR, includes evidence of student learning, and actionable feedback (<i>Focus Area 2.2b Metric 4</i>) • Document a clear and intentional process to fully support teacher candidates individually who may fall behind in their coursework or clinical experience, that allows EPP staff and the teacher candidate to monitor their progress to get back on track actively (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.3a Metric 2, 2.3b Metric 4</i>) • Revise syllabi to ensure candidates recognize the importance of applying methods to assess student work, including collecting data and demonstrating impact on student growth. Incorporate assignments that require analysis by candidates that impact student growth and show their reflection on that growth (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.1a Metric 1, Criteria 2.3b Metric 2</i>)		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction MEETS The EPP demonstrates strong incorporation of best practices around content instruction, as evidenced across its handbooks and program materials. Coursework and residency experiences intentionally integrate nationally recognized strategies, including the use of high-quality instructional materials and evidence-based practices such as the Science of Reading. Candidates engage in scaffolded, mentor-guided clinical placements where they apply content instruction in real classrooms, receiving ongoing formative feedback to refine their practice. Performance-based assessments, including EDA completion, Praxis, mini-edTPA, and observations evaluated using the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, consistently evaluate candidates’ ability to deliver content effectively, ensuring alignment with state and national standards. Additionally, reflective practice and the PRIDE values (Perseverance, Rapport,

Integrity, Determination, Excellence) are embedded throughout coursework and clinical experiences, supporting the intentional application of best practices in instruction. Evidence of program-wide alignment, such as consistent transition points and performance gates across Phase I–IV progression and alignment with DESE-approved performance-based assessments, further supports that content instruction is systematically scaffolded and intentionally reinforced throughout the candidate experience. The use of course-embedded measures and tools like LiveText also provides continuous, data-driven feedback to inform instructional decision-making and ensure fidelity to best practices.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=5) reported engagement with high-quality instructional materials in math and reading. In math classes, for example, students worked on place value concepts using the Eureka Math curriculum. Coursework often required students to not only deliver lessons but also to evaluate the instructional materials, including identifying relevant standards and assessing how the materials support learning objectives. In American education seminars, participants practiced analyzing lesson plans and determining the effectiveness of instructional materials, fostering skills in instructional evaluation. In reading coursework, students engaged with the science of reading, focusing on phonics and sound-based approaches rather than relying solely on sight word memorization. An instructor in the Course Instructor focus group (n=4) said, “I intentionally incorporate high-quality instructional materials (HQIMs) to model best practices in content instruction and to help students align their lessons to academic standards. Even though I do not teach reading or math directly, I expose students to HQIMs from a variety of content areas, including social studies, science, and math, so they can analyze evidence-based strategies, scaffolding techniques, and inclusive practices. I guide students to select HQIMs, evaluate their alignment with standards, and determine how technology or media might enhance the lesson, such as using a Smartboard or interactive simulation effectively rather than mechanically following instructions.” Participants gave multiple examples. In a social studies lesson, students might choose an interactive map from an HQIM, align it to state standards, and design differentiated activities for diverse learners. In a science lesson, students might analyze a digital lab simulation and create an assessment that measures understanding of the scientific concept. Within the PLT, students pull HQIMs from multiple content areas, evaluate the materials for accessibility, rigor, and instructional support, and reflect on how these resources inform their own lesson planning.

Reviewers saw evidence of best practices in course observations. In General Methods (EDUC4303), they noted, “The course integrates nationally recognized frameworks such as Charlotte Danielson’s Framework for Teaching, TPACK, and Borich & Blanchette’s Effective Teaching Methods. Weekly chapter activities and discussion forums promote active learning and reflection. The Teacher Work Sample (TWS) assignment requires candidates to design instruction based on contextual factors, learning goals, and assessment data—demonstrating alignment with research-based instructional planning.”

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

MEETS

The EPP consistently integrates and utilizes the Arkansas K–12 Standards throughout coursework and clinical experiences, ensuring candidates develop a strong foundation for effective teaching. Coursework in Phase I–IV explicitly aligns lessons, assignments, and assessments with Arkansas state standards, helping candidates understand expectations across all grade bands within their licensure area. For example, the “Teach PRIDE Residency Handbook” emphasizes that lesson planning and instruction during the year-long residency are guided by High-Quality Instructional Materials aligned to state standards, including content-specific benchmarks. Additionally, performance-based assessments such as the mini-edTPA, EDA, and Aspiring Teacher Rubric evaluate candidates’ ability to apply Arkansas K–12 Standards in instruction, ensuring alignment between coursework, clinical practice, and state expectations. The “Field and Clinical Experience Handbook” further supports this alignment by requiring mentor-guided application of Arkansas Standards during classroom placements, with structured feedback to reinforce best practices in state-standard-aligned teaching.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=5) gave examples of using the K–12 Standards. In reading coursework, candidates explored phonics-based instructional strategies consistent with the science of reading, aiming to apply literacy standards across grade levels. Additionally, American education seminars included activities in which candidates analyzed and evaluated instructional materials, with attention to relevant standards and alignment, providing a framework for vertically integrating skills and concepts throughout the licensure area. Course Instructors also shared the example of using standards in lesson planning assignments. Students were taught to align objectives with the standards. They discussed unpacking standards and the vertical alignment of standards. An example included an activity in which students were given standards at three different grade levels and then had to collaborate on the differences in grade-level progressions.

In all three course observations, reviewers saw evidence of the Standards. In Classroom and Behavior Management (EDUC4304), reviewers noted that in Week 6, candidates design a Classroom Management Plan aligned with standards for creating supportive learning environments. In Week 5, they explore strategies for building relationships with families to meet collaboration standards. Observation of peer-led mini-lessons, such as the “Order of Operations” lesson, further reinforces how clear lesson structure and engaging strategies reduce off-task behavior and support positive classroom management.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates’ coursework supports their development as a teacher
APPROACHING

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses
MEETS

The EPP intentionally sequences coursework across all programs to build candidate knowledge, skills, and dispositions progressively, with opportunities for reinforcement and mastery. Foundational courses introduce core concepts and early field experiences, mid-level courses reinforce curriculum design, classroom management, and assessment, and advanced coursework and the year-long residency require demonstration of instructional planning and delivery aligned with HQIM, Arkansas K–12 Standards, and the Science of Reading. Evidence includes revised degree plans for SPED, Elementary, and Secondary/Broad Range programs, which align courses with program checkpoints, field experiences, and Praxis preparation. Sequence progression charts and the Undergraduate EPP Advising Guide show scaffolded coursework from theory to applied practice, culminating in internships, portfolio projects, and edTPA tasks, providing a clear, structured pathway that progressively increases rigor and prepares candidates for licensure and effective classroom practice.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group shared an example from their methods courses, saying, “We taught mini-lessons that required us to apply prior knowledge and receive feedback.” It allowed them to reflect on instructional practices and improve teaching skills. Course instructors explained that courses build in rigor, saying “lesson plan expectations are different at different levels; lower level courses are introductions to lesson planning, 300 level courses dive a little deeper, and 400 level we expect proficiency.”

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework
APPROACHING

The EPP somewhat integrates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards throughout coursework to develop candidates’ knowledge and skills across all licensure areas. Courses are mapped to state competencies and standards, ensuring that candidates progressively build expertise in planning, instruction, assessment, classroom environment, and professional responsibilities. Evidence includes the “AR Educator Competencies Elementary K–6” and “AR Teaching Standards EPP Core Courses” matrices, which show how foundational and advanced courses introduce, reinforce, and require demonstration of state standards through assignments, field experiences, and performance assessments. The “HQIM K–6 Elementary and SOR Content Competencies” provide additional evidence, illustrating how candidates learn to deliver evidence-based instruction aligned with Arkansas content and literacy standards. Finally, the “TESS for Aspiring Teachers” matrix demonstrates how coursework and clinical experiences prepare candidates for evaluation under Arkansas’s teaching standards, reinforcing reflective practice and continuous professional growth.

Participants in the Course Instructor focus group shared that candidates are introduced to the standards through coursework in lesson planning, assessment design, and instructional methods, which helps them begin to understand the expectations tied to their licensure. However, while there is clear evidence of alignment on paper, the intentional integration of these standards into day-to-day coursework and candidate practice is still developing and is not fully consistent across courses. For example, candidates referenced aligning lessons to standards in specific classes, but this practice was not yet evident across all areas of study.

In all three course observations, reviewers saw some evidence of the competencies and teaching standards. However, an explicit connection was not made to the standards for teacher candidates, and there was no evidence of an intentional connection between coursework and application. While the submitted documents show standards in the coursework, they were not evident in practice, and student application was not evident in discussions or coursework observations.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

Coursework is intentionally aligned to clinical experiences. Foundational courses introduce theory and observation, mid-level courses reinforce methods and assessment applied in field placements, and advanced coursework culminates in a year-long residency where candidates demonstrate mastery. Candidates engage in structured reflection with instructors and clinical supervisors, connecting theory to practice. For example, Elementary Education candidates complete foundational literacy and pedagogy courses before residency, applying strategies with real students. SPED candidates create mock IEPs in coursework and implement them during Internship I and II under supervision.

Participants in the Coursework focus group (n=5) reported that their experiences at sites such as the Boys and Girls Club directly reinforced coursework on foundational reading skills, including helping children with reading and spelling, which allowed them to apply instructional strategies in authentic contexts. Additionally, school-based experiences involved teaching different lessons across grade levels and observing classroom behavior, aligning with coursework in both instructional methods and classroom management. Participants also noted that structured school tours and guided placements helped them feel confident and prepared to teach lessons, rather than simply completing requirements for school approval. Course Instructors (n=5) further confirmed this, sharing that candidates participate in Learning Tours before the internship, during which they have the opportunity to teach lessons and co-teach. Candidates are also given opportunities for a structured reflection session. Candidates are given time to note differences across schools and grade levels, and to share their observations with classmates.

In all three observations, reviewers noted alignment with clinical experiences. In Introduction to Education (EDUC2300), candidates are required to complete 10 hours of field experience, which supports the connection between theory and practice.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors demonstrate deep knowledge of Arkansas K–12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. Instructors hold advanced degrees, including Ed.D. and Ph.D., in relevant fields such as Organizational Leadership, Special Education, and Health Education, and most maintain current Arkansas teaching credentials. Many have substantial PreK–12 teaching experience, ranging from 5 to 14 years, ensuring they bring practical classroom expertise to their instruction. All instructors have received training in the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, supporting consistent evaluation of candidate performance. Several instructors also serve as clinical supervisors, strengthening the alignment between coursework and field experiences.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=4) spoke highly of their course instructors. One participant recognized one of their instructors as someone who “demonstrates expertise by guiding us through assignments, modeling instructional strategies, and offering detailed feedback.” Similarly, instructors provide targeted support, answer questions thoroughly, and supply additional materials when needed, ensuring candidates understand course content. All participants reported feeling well-prepared for assignments and classroom applications, reflecting the instructors’ strong subject knowledge and commitment to candidate development.

In all three course observations, reviewers observed evidence of deep knowledge from each instructor. In one course, the review team noted, “The instructor brings advanced content knowledge and pedagogical expertise, extensive PreK–12 teaching experience, training in evaluation rubrics, and expertise in instructional leadership, high-quality instructional materials, and classroom management strategies. Their ongoing professional development and role as a clinical supervisor ensure that candidates receive consistent guidance and feedback, strengthening the connection between coursework and practical classroom application.”

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors have a proven history and show evidence of strong facilitation and providing support. The EPP has an evaluation system in place to capture feedback on course instructors from candidates, the program chair, and peers; however, survey results were not provided for each evaluation. The “SOE Mid-Semester Evaluation” shows candidate comments and feedback, which are generally positive and highlight that candidates feel that they are supported in their coursework by the instructor.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=4) discussed how instructors provide assignments and activities that simulate real teaching experiences, creating opportunities for candidates to practice instructional strategies and reflect on their learning. Participants also reported receiving quality, timely feedback; for instance, advisors and instructors helped guide candidates who were struggling academically by connecting them with tutors, mentoring them, and encouraging them to improve their GPAs and continue in the program.

Course instructor effectiveness was also evident in the coursework observations. In General Methods (EUC4304), the syllabus outlines clear expectations, structured feedback timelines, and diverse instructional methods (e.g., lectures, case studies, technology-enhanced lessons). The instructor provides weekly feedback, synchronous sessions, and support on Blackboard. Assignments are graded by Thursday, and emails are answered within 48 hours. The Teacher Work Sample includes the candidate's reflection on teaching effectiveness, which models the instructor's emphasis on continuous improvement.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

Documentation provides evidence that the sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds. The sequence begins with Field Experience I, then Field Experience II, and Residency. Clinical experiences that allow for development and learning are found in Field Experience I. Candidates are required to complete 40 hours of clinical practice across multiple foundational courses (i.e., EDUC 1300, EDUC 3302, SPED 2300, and EDUC 3303), where specific requirements are met via guided observation, reflection, and mini-teaching assignments. The "Teacher Work Sample" assignment serves as a capstone assessment that requires candidates to demonstrate mastery in specific areas (i.e., planning, instruction, assessment, reflection). Field Experience Level II shows the EPP's effort to expand candidates' responsibilities, to reinforce content-specific pedagogy and assessment through multiple methods courses (i.e., ELED 3332, EDUC 4304), and to offer candidates authentic experiences in school settings that align with theory to practice. These courses and their designs are intended to represent the next level of the gradual release model during Field Experience Level II.

All candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=4) agreed that the sequence of clinical experiences allows for a gradual increase in rigor and level of responsibility expected of teacher candidates. They described how clinical experiences begin with some classroom observation hours during introductory courses, and build to hands-on activities with small groups of students in methods courses, and then culminate in a one-year supervised residency. Candidates also agreed that field experiences were sequenced to build on content learned in coursework the year before.

Clinical Supervisors (n=5) all agreed that experiences are well sequenced to gradually increase the level of responsibility that candidates hold for instruction, from observation hours to classroom projects to co-teaching to total teaching. These experiences are sequenced across the introductory Field Experiences 1, the intermediate Field Experiences 2, and the one-year residency.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

APPROACHING

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides some opportunities for candidates to work with students of varied learning needs. The EPP provided district demographic data for five partnering districts (PBSD, FCSD, White Hall, Watson, and Dumas School District). Candidates have ample opportunities to work with varied populations during Field Experience I and Field Experience II among the five partnering districts.

Candidates in the focus group (n=4) spoke about opportunities to work with students who have IEPs or 504s. Participants also shared that they have had the opportunity to observe multiple teachers across different content areas and diverse schools, as well as opportunities to differentiate instruction based on students' individual learning styles. Course Instructors added that candidates are expected to demonstrate how they engage students with different needs (primarily those who have IEPs and 504s) in the classroom and to differentiate accordingly.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

APPROACHING

Some experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate that they have the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. The EPP conducts a one-day academy for mentors, and the "Mentor Teacher Handbook" and "Mentor Teacher Checklist" outline their responsibilities and expectations so their candidates can be successful during clinical teaching. While the EPP uses a two-way evaluation process to give feedback, the feedback sample provided is not aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, and no evidence was submitted to demonstrate the actual coaching and feedback provided to candidates. It is unclear if the EPP monitors or tracks the four informal observations that mentor teachers are expected to complete each year.

Participants in the Mentor teacher focus group (n=4) had over 20 years of experience and at least a master's degree. Mentors have attended many professional development opportunities, including AVID, Marzano, and multiple coaching and mentoring trainings. All candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=4) agreed that their mentor teachers are effective supports for clinical experiences, particularly in co-planning lessons, preparing lesson materials, integrating HQIM, and providing feedback. Candidates also liked the gradual release of responsibility they experienced with their mentor teachers through the EPP's suggested co-teaching progression.

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

The EPP has a clear and intentional process with specific criteria for the selection of mentors that are aligned with DESE requirements. There is a process for selecting mentors that includes a system for tracking available mentors and their performance, coaching and training, and credentials. While the EPP has identified continuous improvement and evaluation process steps in the EPP's "Selection Process" document, there is no evidence of implementation and results.

Participants in the Partnership focus group (n=2) confirmed that the selection of experienced mentor teachers follows a formal process aligned with the criteria outlined in the mentor teacher manual. Mentor teachers are chosen based on the following criteria: A minimum of three years of classroom experience, demonstrated instructional effectiveness, a strong investment in the Pine Bluff community, and positive relationships with colleagues. Training is provided by the EPP and supplemented by district-level structures.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors demonstrate effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. The EPP presents evidence that the clinical supervisors have received training in effective instructional practices from US Prep. While there is evidence of an intended evaluation for a clinical supervisor and an evaluation form in the "Site Coordinator Guidebook," there is no evidence of the EPP's tracking of clinical supervisors, documentation of the supervisors' training in ATR, or evaluation or survey results that demonstrate the supervisors' history of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact.

All candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=4) agreed that their clinical supervisors are an effective support during clinical experiences, primarily through practical and beneficial feedback given after each classroom observation and ongoing encouragement that ensures feedback "does not tear [them] down but builds [them] up." Candidates see their clinical supervisors as expert resources for managing classroom behavior and engaging diverse learners.

Reviewers saw evidence of strong coaching in all three coaching observations. In one observation, they noted that the clinical supervisor showed evidence of effective instructional practices (i.e., introduces or reinforces certain practices, such as scaffolding, connotation vs denotation, and co-curricular) during the pre- and post-conference with the teacher candidate. The clinical supervisor demonstrated coaching skills throughout the conversation, such as asking questions, paraphrasing, reaffirming the teacher's candidate's planning of an HQIM, and the delivery of the lesson (i.e., changes seen in Domain 2, specifically 2E).

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

APPROACHING

Candidates sometimes receive high-quality feedback from their clinical supervisor that is frequent, both written and oral, connected to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, clearly linked to evidence of student learning during observed lessons, and built on the previous feedback. The EPP has streamlined the POP cycle to give frequent and consistent feedback through the creation of several informative documents, such as the cycle form, checklist, and schedule, that are used by the candidate, the supervisor, and the mentor teacher. The evaluation form used to assess candidate performance is aligned to ATR. The EPP presents evidence of providing high-quality feedback through the "Evaluation Form." However, there was some misalignment with the depth of knowledge of each component of the ATR and the use of generic and subjective feedback language, for example, "the student intern provided a good assessment with the exit ticket response."

Candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=4) shared that they receive oral feedback in the moment while teaching or immediately after lessons (primarily from their mentor teachers) and written feedback aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric on formal evaluations (primarily from their clinical supervisor). All candidates agreed that feedback is frequent, with debriefs consistently held at the start and end of each day at school. They also gave several examples of in-the-moment feedback from their mentors based on student learning, such as teaching the lesson using a different format (PowerPoint) or using manipulatives to reinforce concepts. Candidates did not mention alignment of the feedback to the previous feedback they had received. Clinical Supervisors (n=5) explained that the ATR is used during POP cycles, which are held both virtually and face-to-face. Student data is discussed during POP cycles. However, there was no evidence provided that written feedback is consistently provided or that feedback builds on previous feedback.

In two of the three observations, reviewers noted that oral feedback was not aligned with the ATR. In one coaching observation, the review team stated, "However, the feedback was mostly in response to the candidate's reflection and did not include evidence of student learning. Feedback was not connected to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric despite a clear opportunity to reinforce the candidate's reflection about classroom culture. It is unclear if feedback was also written or if it built on previous feedback." In another observation, the reviewers noted, "the written feedback is limited as notes are provided for the domain overall despite ratings for each specific competency; for example, 1c: Setting Instructional Outcomes was rated as "Unsatisfactory" on the form but no feedback was provided to explain that rating or provide next steps for improvement. The written form is aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric; there were no explicit references to ATR in the oral feedback."

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024-25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

MEETS

There is evidence that the EPP collaborates with its partnering districts and superintendents quarterly and with mentor teachers through regular meetings, as well as co-constructing placement opportunities between the mentor teacher and candidate using a partnership agreement. Timelines are identified and accompanied by specific activities for the mentor teacher and candidate teacher. While there is evidence supporting that the EPP provides mentor teacher training, there is limited evidence presented to demonstrate the inclusion of the clinical supervisors and mentors' collaborative processes beyond the onboarding training.

Participants in the Partnership focus group (n=2) described a strong and evolving partnership between UAPB and local districts. One district leader highlighted intentional collaboration through governance meetings and planning sessions, noting that district expectations are embedded and crosswalked with the EPP's program. They said that the partnership has become more intentional over time, especially in how residents are placed to support retention. They shared that communication between the EPP and districts is both formal and informal. One district requested streamlined communication through the Office of Recruitment and Retention, which has improved coordination and clarity. Candidates participate in school professional development and are gradually integrated into instructional roles.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Processes are in place to develop and support clinical supervisors. Clinical supervisors are continuously trained through the EPP's offerings and US Prep training opportunities. Documentation and processes are available to support

the clinical supervisors when conducting observations, such as the “POP Cycle Packet,” “New Site Coordinator Guide,” and “Post-Conference Coaching Guide.”

Clinical Supervisors identified several professional development opportunities, such as HQIM, cognitive coaching, US PREP, and GoReact, that support their individual and collective growth and development. There were also opportunities to grow and develop through state and national memberships, as well as writing articles.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework APPROACHING

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework MEETS

Candidates are consistently successful in their coursework, as evidenced by academic performance and program structures that support progression. The “GPA Alignment Documents” from 2021–2025 show consistent growth in median GPA from entry to exit across cohorts, indicating academic development and mastery of coursework. In Fall 2021, the median GPA increased from 3.405 at entry to 3.493 at exit; in Spring 2024, it rose from 3.637 to 3.6493. Additionally, cohort data from 2021–2023 shows that candidates maintained at least a 3.0 GPA throughout the program.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework APPROACHING

Candidates are sometimes provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are not on track. The “2025–2027 Recruitment and Retention Plan” includes a system to track candidate progress in coursework, with early alerts triggered by a GPA below 2.75, grades of C or lower in gateway courses, attendance concerns, or faculty referrals. Candidates identified as “off-track” are provided with individualized support plans (ISPs), which include targeted Praxis bootcamps, tutoring, progress monitoring, and accountability measures. While the procedures and templates indicate a structured and proactive support system, no data were provided to confirm that candidate support is consistently implemented or effective, such as usage rates, outcomes, or candidate feedback.

Participants in the Course Instructor focus group (n=4) discussed their process for supporting candidates. Initially, faculty engage candidates through office hours and personal conversations. One participant gave a recent example of assigning a peer mentor to help a student navigate a challenging class. If informal efforts are insufficient, a formal plan is developed collaboratively between instructors and the candidate, with one instructor noting that these plans may “escalate to the Success Center for additional resources such as verified accommodations or disposition reviews.” Academic support is further reinforced through referrals to tutors, success coaches, and counselors, with candidates actively participating in identifying needs, setting goals, and tracking progress.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship APPROACHING

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones APPROACHING

The program has a set of goals and milestones for candidates’ clinical internship. The Field and Clinical Experiences Handbook outlines candidate responsibilities and clinical experience expectations, including observations aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, minimum GPA requirements, capstone projects, Praxis passage, and progress toward licensure. However, there was no data or tracker to determine how many candidates met these goals.

Only two of the four candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group felt like their program had a set of goals and milestones for candidates’ clinical internship. The only milestones referenced were passing Praxis and following the suggested co-teaching schedule. The candidates believed themselves to be ahead of schedule but did not reference what informed that belief. Clinical Supervisors identified the following goals for candidates: (being) “Day 1 ready”, passing the Praxis exam(s), continuing through the program on pace, and being hireable after graduation. No specific expectations for candidates’ performance during the clinical internship were discussed, but the majority of progress

monitoring discussed is based on formal observation ratings. Supervisors report that most candidates meet clinical experience goals and milestones due to program completion rates.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

APPROACHING

There is some evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. The “LiveText Assessment Reports” and lesson plans show that candidates use student data to inform instructional decisions, aligning their teaching strategies with identified learning needs. Portfolio artifacts and POP Cycle Data further illustrate how candidates engage in reflective practice, adjusting instruction based on student performance and feedback. These artifacts suggest that candidates are developing the skills necessary to support K–12 student growth. However, no direct evidence was provided showing measurable student growth outcomes (e.g., pre/post assessments, growth scores, or student work samples).

Candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=4) agreed that they were supported with collecting and assessing student data, but they did not provide any specific examples of how they have used data to identify specific student needs or to drive instruction. Candidates named classroom test and quiz grades as their primary sources of data, as well as confidential student testing data shared with them by their mentor teacher. One candidate mentioned using common formative assessments, but could not speak to how the data from those is used. Mentor teachers reported working with their candidates to review high-level assessment data, such as ATLAS interim tests, as well as day-to-day data like exit tickets and class participation. Clinical Supervisors provided general examples of student growth but didn’t provide specific examples, assignments, or conversations when student data was discussed regularly.

In all three coaching observations, reviewers saw some evidence of student growth being discussed, but the conversations did not encourage candidates to analyze and use the data to improve. One review team noted, “The clinical supervisor asked the candidate prompting questions about how she will monitor student learning during the next lesson and give students individualized feedback in order to ensure each one achieves mastery of the current skill. However, the observation did not include any discussion of actual data analysis or how that data will be used to drive instruction.”

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

APPROACHING

Some candidates demonstrate proficiency in effective teaching skills, as measured by performance on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric and other clinical evaluation tools. “The Undergraduate Formal Observation” spreadsheet for the 2023–2024 cohort includes average scores from three formal observations based on the ATR rubric, suggesting that candidates are evaluated multiple times during their clinical experience. On average, evaluation results are “progressing.” The average score during Fall 2023 was 2.67, Spring 2024 was 2.07, and Fall 2024 was 2.29.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

APPROACHING

Candidates sometimes receive support throughout the clinical internship. The “TESS Intensive Support Professional Growth Plan” template was provided as evidence. However, no additional evidence was provided to highlight how candidates are flagged for needing support, conversations about the support plan, or evidence of how successful support plans are.

All candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=4) agreed that they had the support they needed, but no candidate made any mention of individualized support plans. Candidates only have general check-ins with their mentor and clinical supervisor to answer questions and problem-solve challenges. Another candidate mentioned not knowing what support was available, as he hadn’t had any negative experiences in his field placement that would require additional support.

Clinical Supervisors shared that the majority of support is informal and involves collaboration between the clinical supervisor, experienced mentor teacher, and school administrators. If candidates continue to struggle, then they meet with the dean, licensure officer, and site coordinator to be placed on a formal plan. However, only one of four supervisors spoke of formal plans.

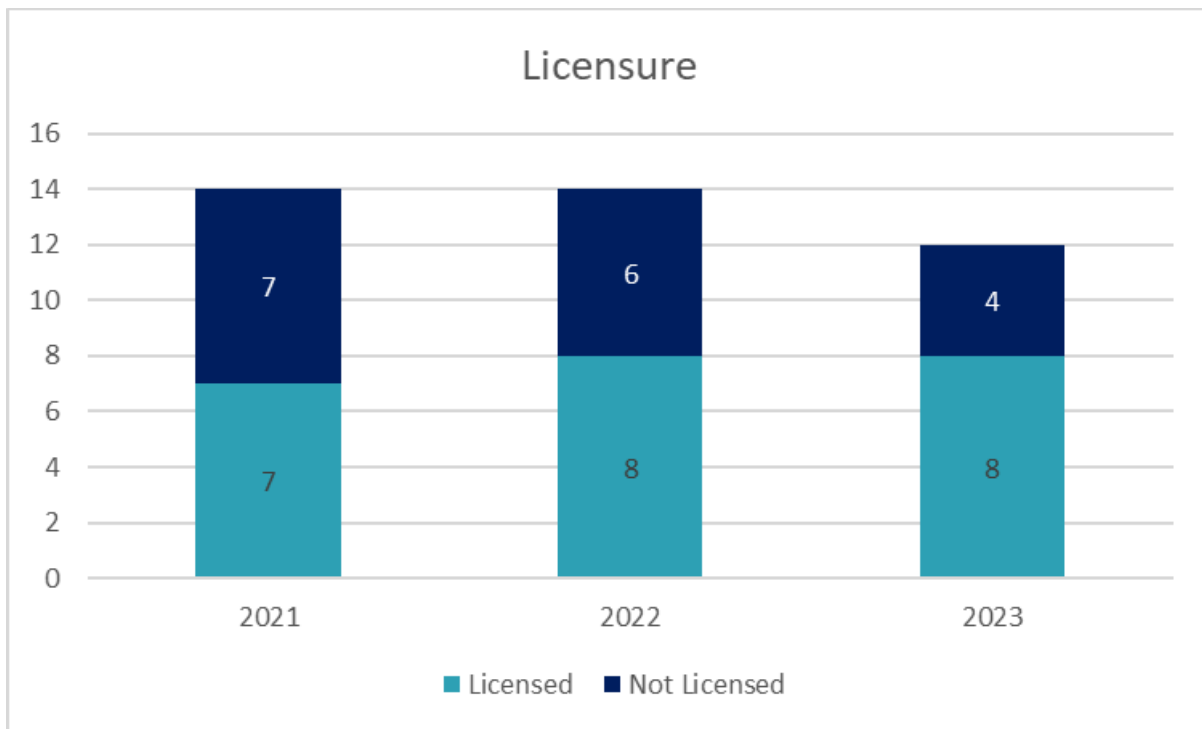
One teacher candidate spoke about opportunities that encourage retention, which included attending conferences as a member of the National Education Association. Clinical Supervisors encourage high-performing candidates to work as an Aspiring Teacher, but no additional evidence was provided.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
BELOW	APPROACHING	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that Traditional program completers are prepared to obtain standard licensure and are employed in Arkansas schools. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 3.1a, Criteria 3.2a)</i> - Establish programmatic support to ensure that traditional program completers are prepared to pass the content exam on their first try. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.1c)</i>		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license	80%	58%	BELOW

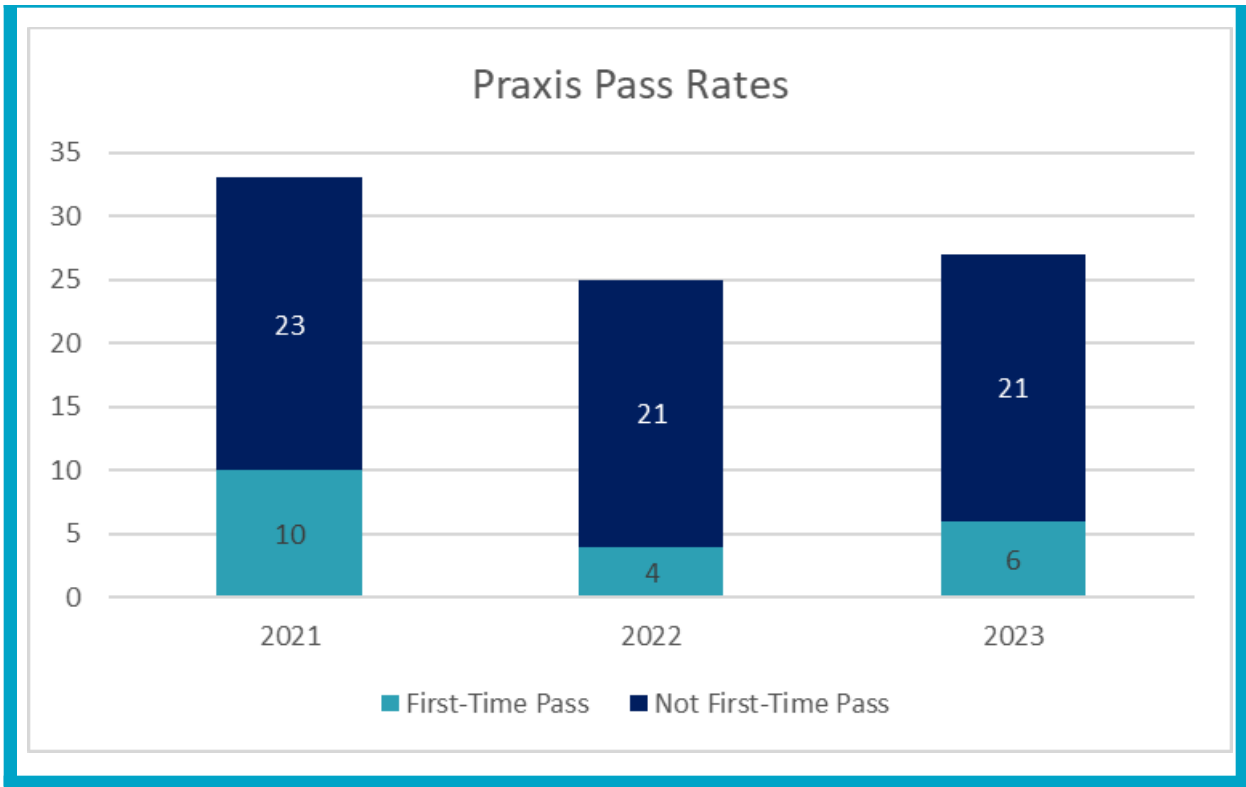


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	73%	n/a	n/a

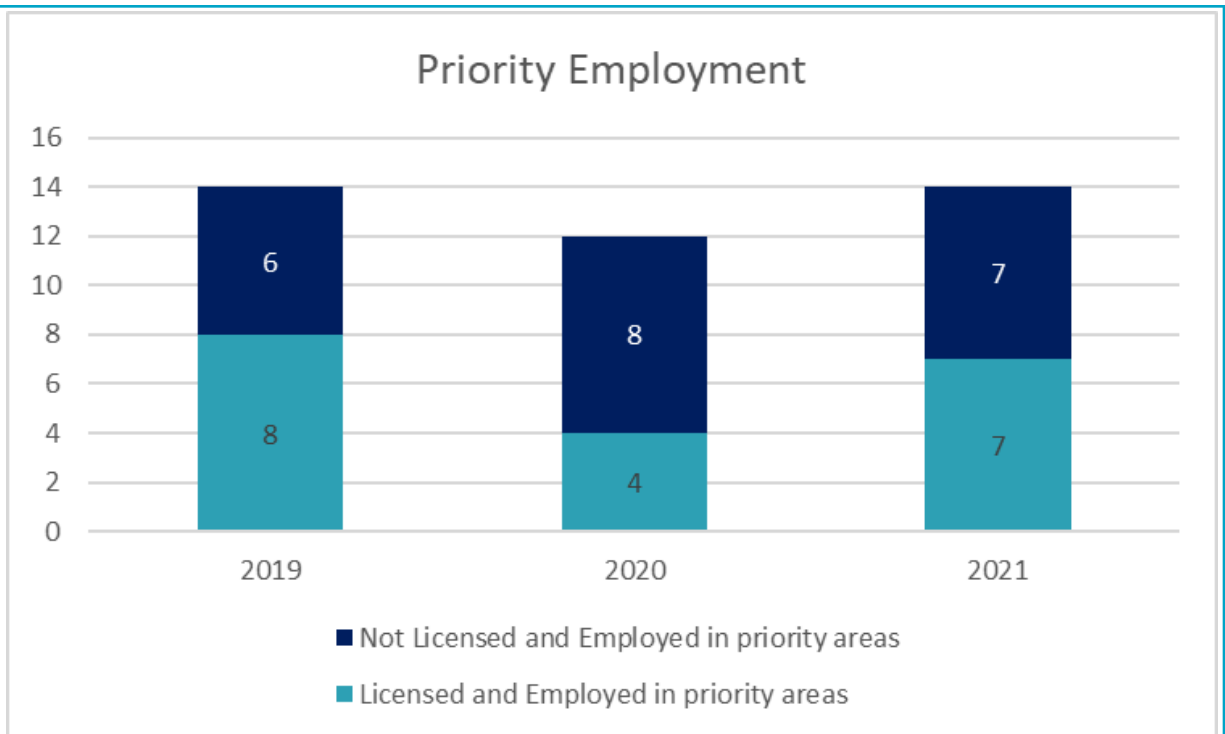
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	66%	24%	BELOW



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	68%	53%	BELOW												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and Employed</th><th>Not Licensed and Employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2019</td><td>9</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>4</td><td>8</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>8</td><td>6</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed	2019	9	5	2020	4	8	2021	8	6
Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed													
2019	9	5													
2020	4	8													
2021	8	6													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	39%	46%	EXCEEDS												



*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

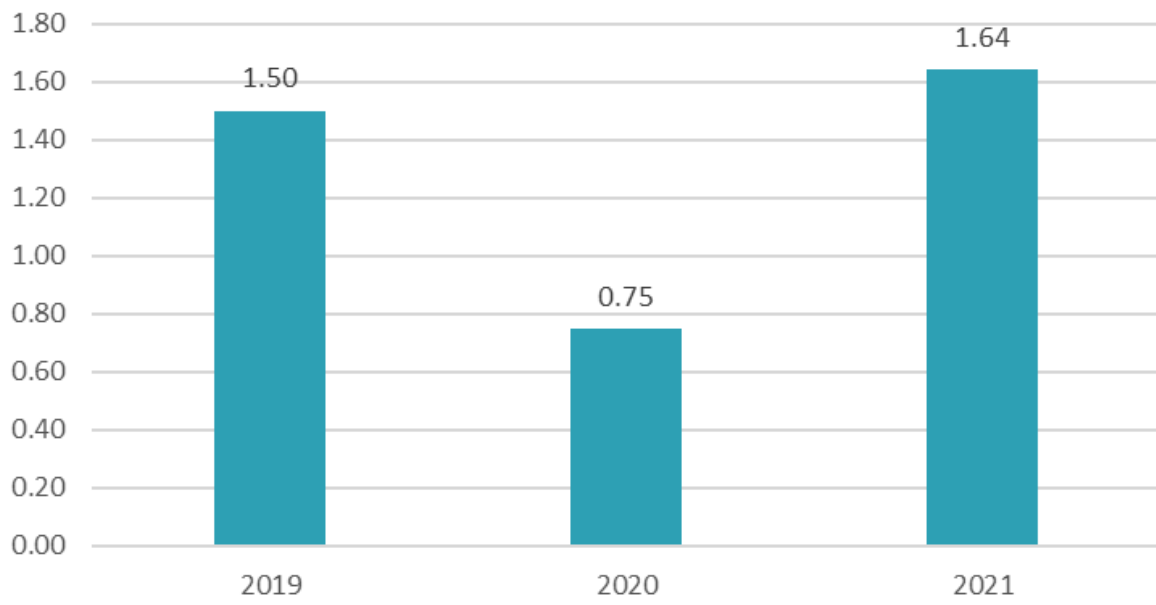
Current subject shortage areas for employment: Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.8	1.3	MEETS

Average Experience 3 Years After Completion



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	78%	86%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	79%	82%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	44%	EXCEEDS

